Unit 9

Imitation

New: Simple counterpoint: one hand answers the other with the same tune

In imitation, one voice plays a tune and another voice repeats it a little later, while the first voice goes on with something new. It is the oldest trick in counterpoint, and the simplest kind of music in which two voices are truly equal. In this unit the right hand plays a short tune and the left hand answers with the same tune, an octave or two lower, two bars later.

What is new

Spot the tune once, play it twice

The left hand's entry looks exactly like the right hand's first two bars, moved down. You have already read it, so you can watch the right hand while the left hand repeats it.

The other voice keeps going

While the left hand imitates, the right hand plays a new, slower line above it. Hold its long notes for their full length.

Rounds and canons

When the second voice copies the whole tune, the piece is a round or canon, like Frère Jacques.

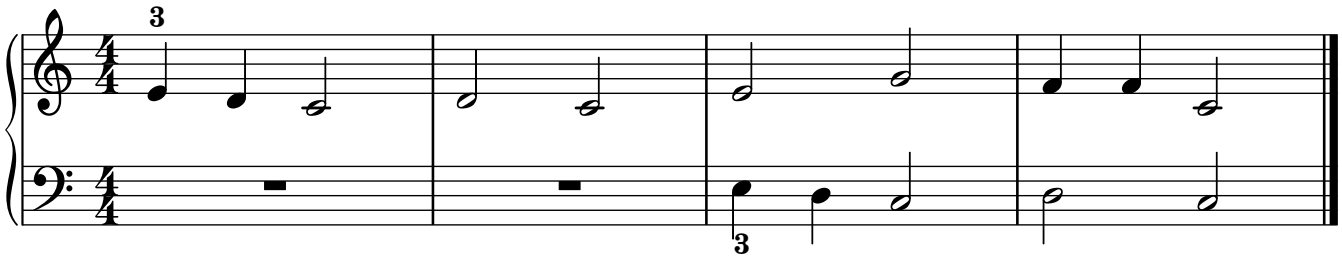
Reading tips

1. In your scan, compare bars 1-2 (right hand) with bars 3-4 (left hand): the shape is the same.
2. Bring out whichever hand has the tune at the moment.
3. Count the rests at the start carefully, so the left hand comes in exactly on time.

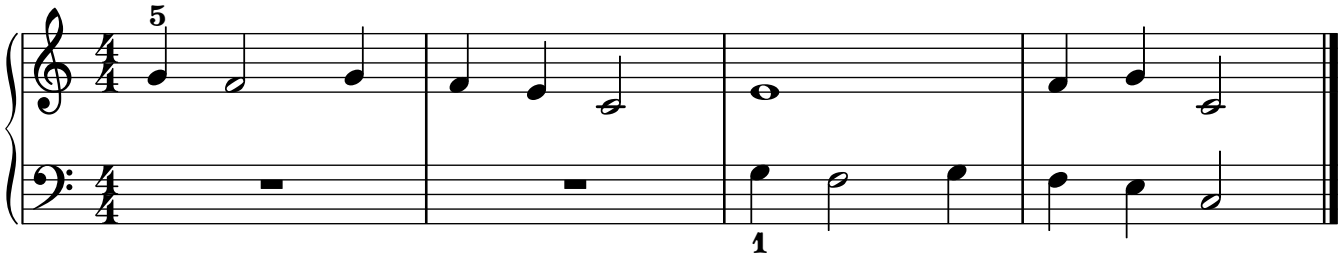
Part A: The left hand answers ♩ = 60

C major, four bars: the left hand repeats the right hand's tune an octave lower.

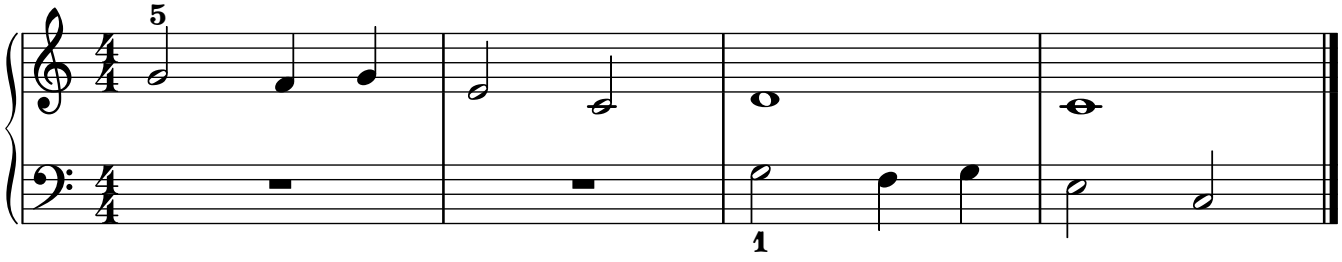
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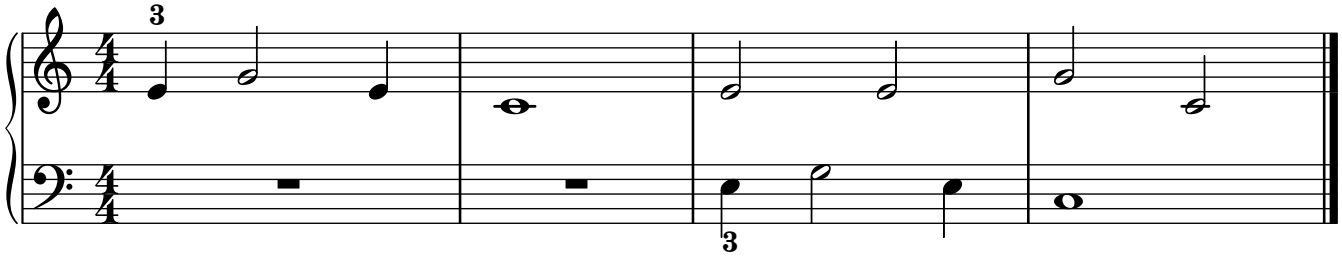
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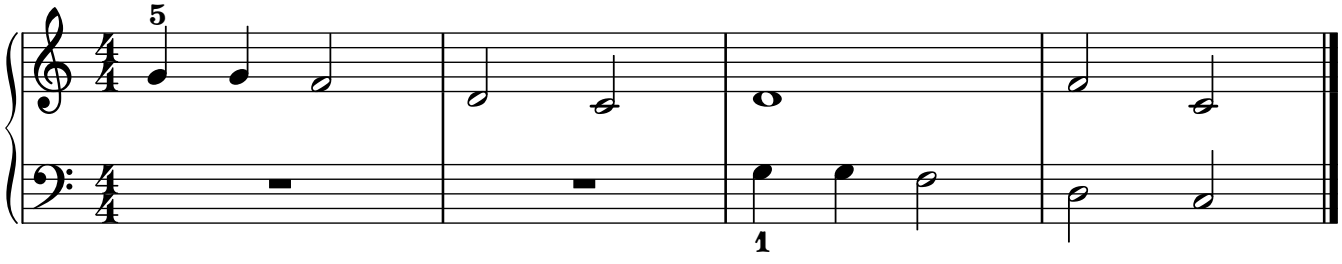
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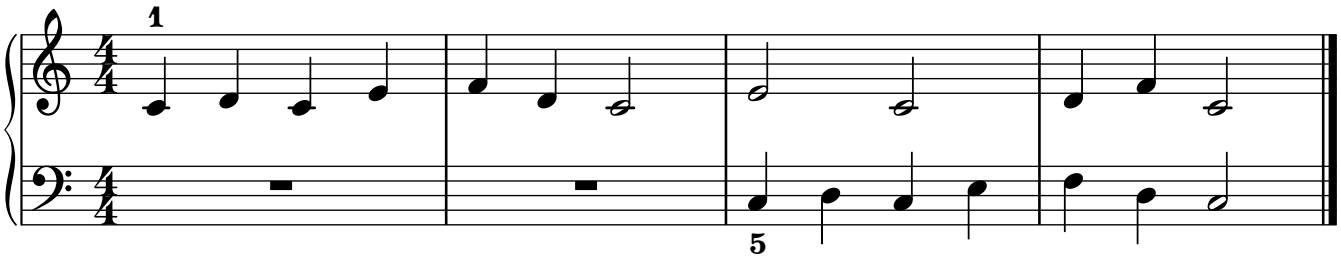
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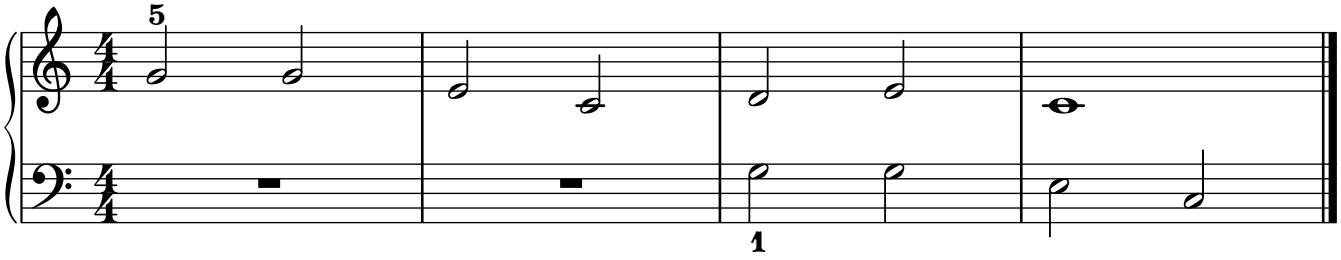
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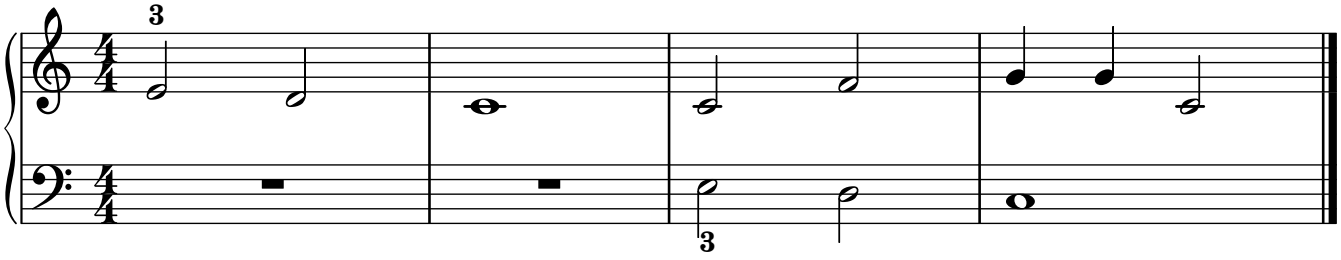
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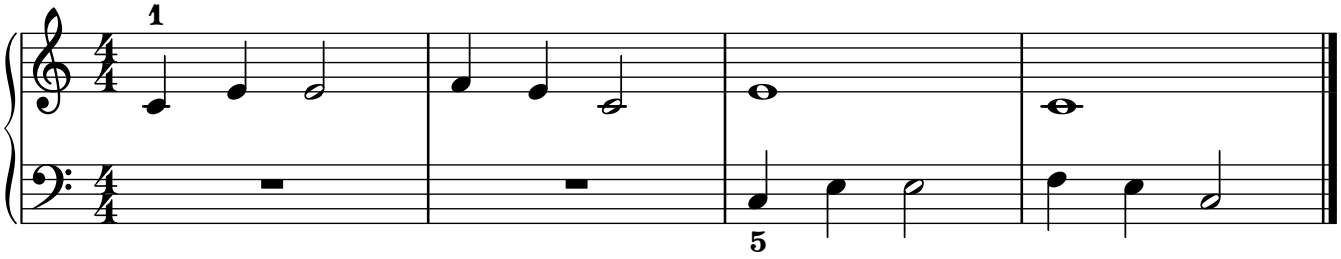
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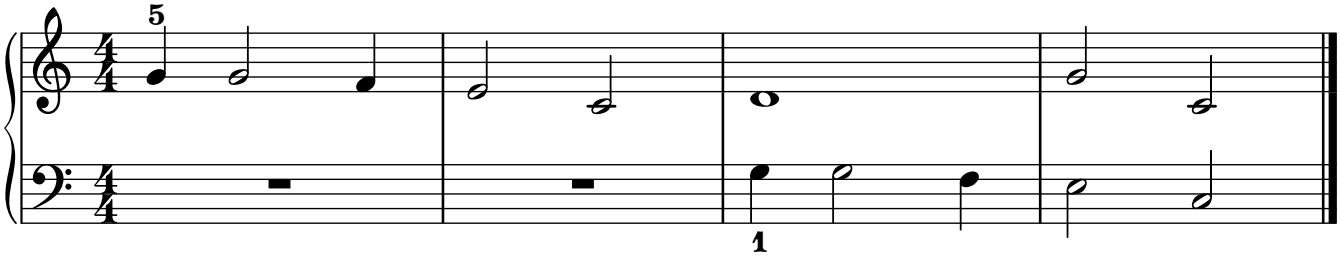
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9.9



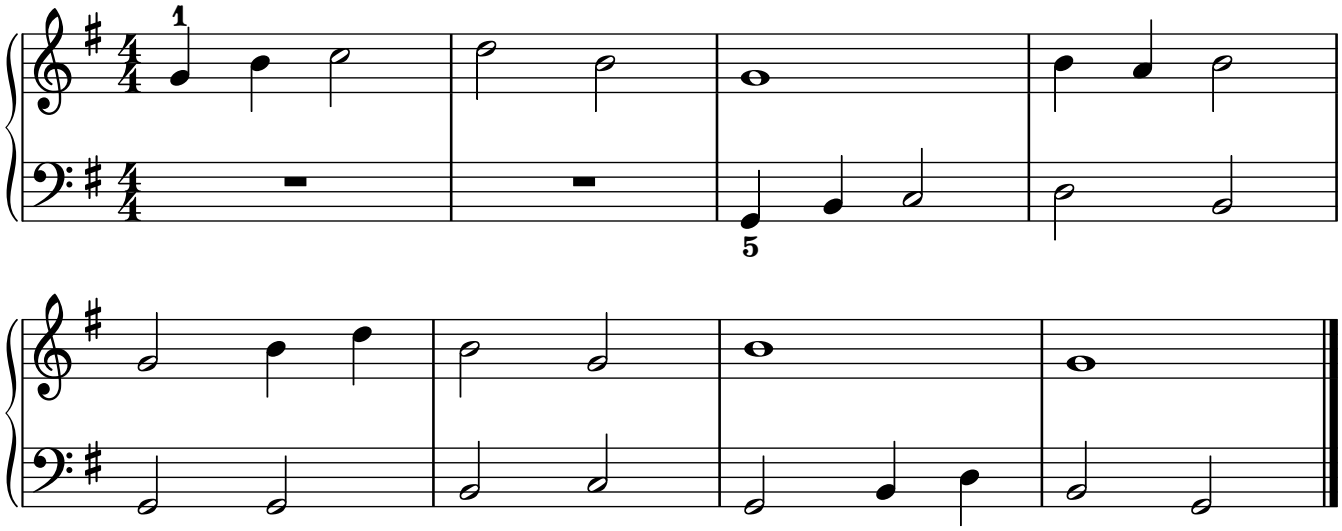
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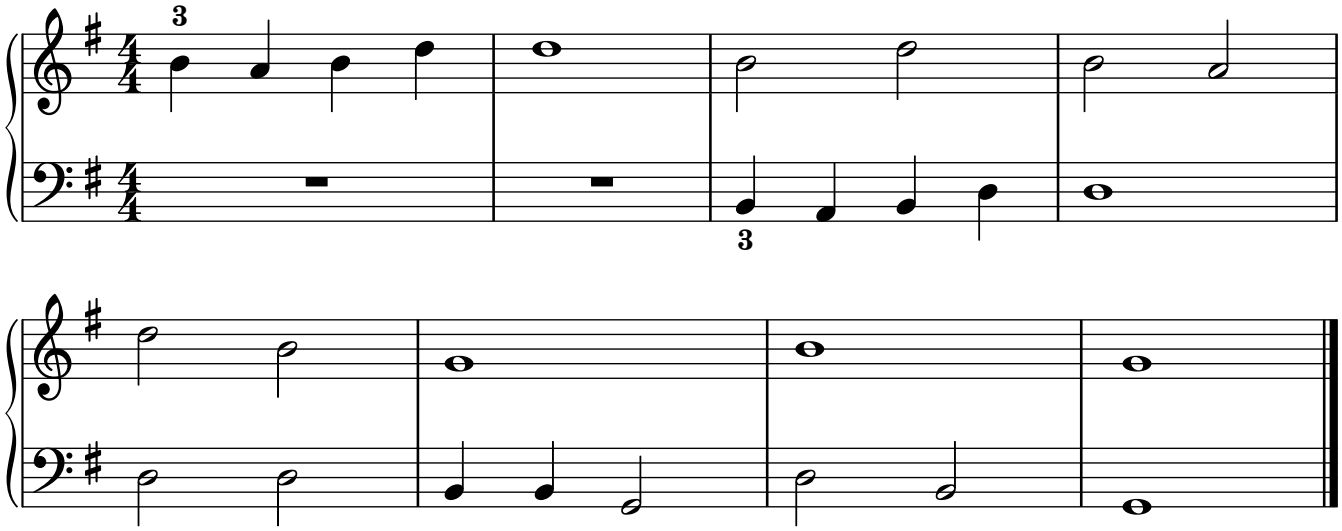
Part B: Two tunes, two answers ♩ = 60

G major, eight bars: two tunes, each answered two octaves lower. In bars 5-6 the left hand has a counter-melody under the second tune.

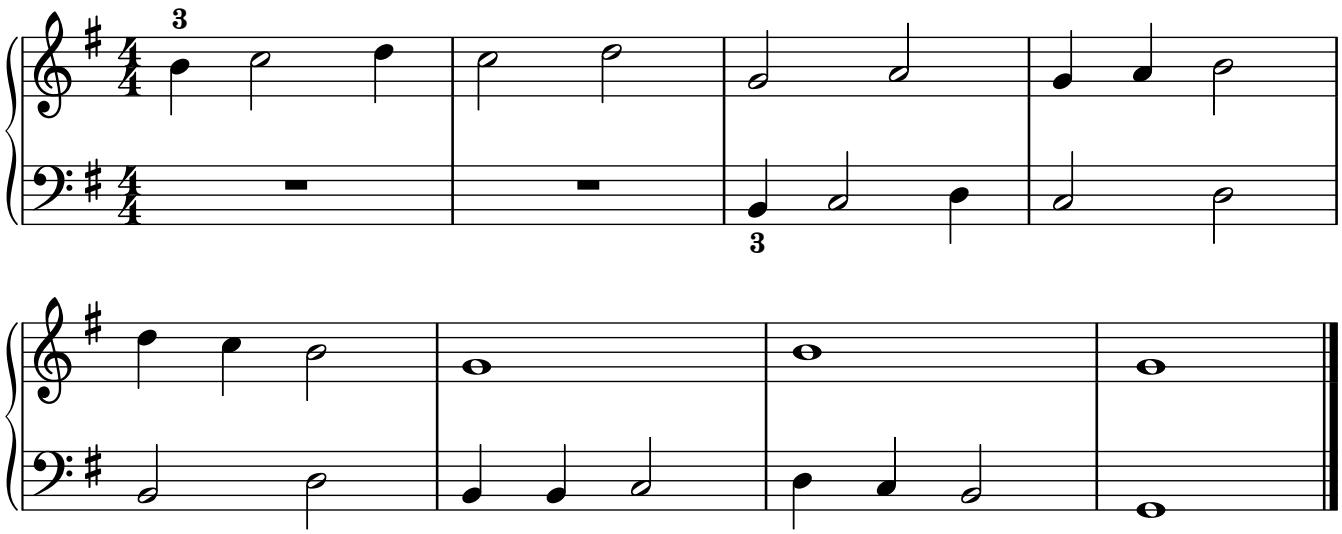
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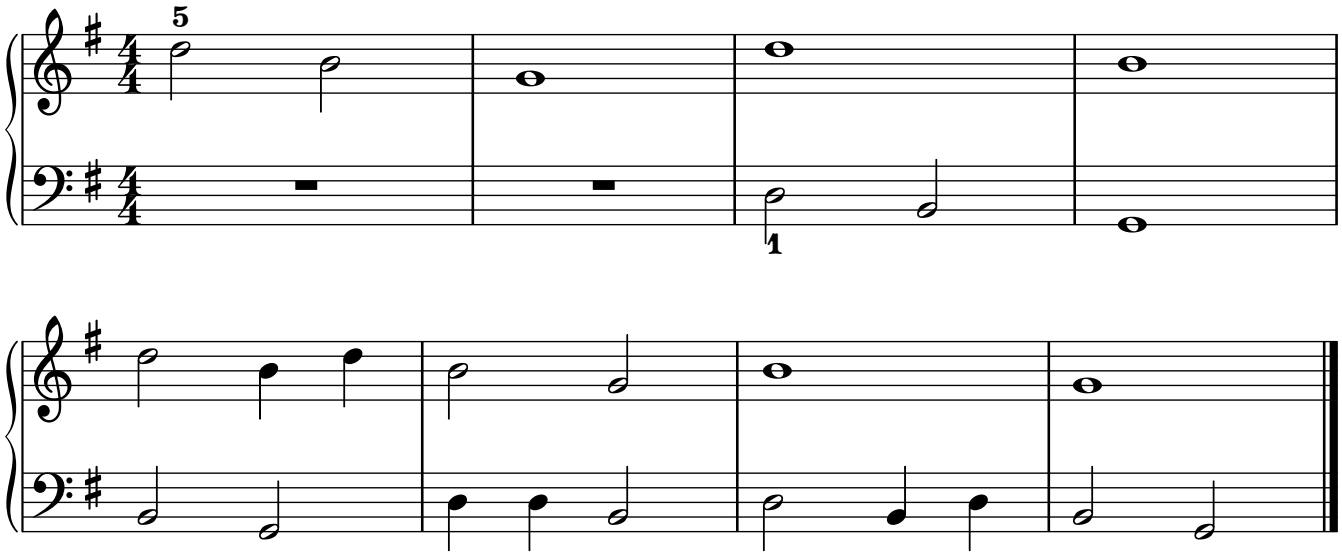


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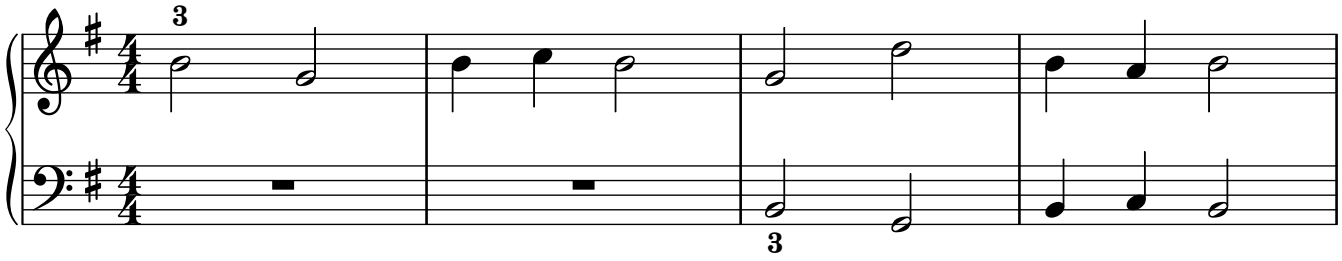
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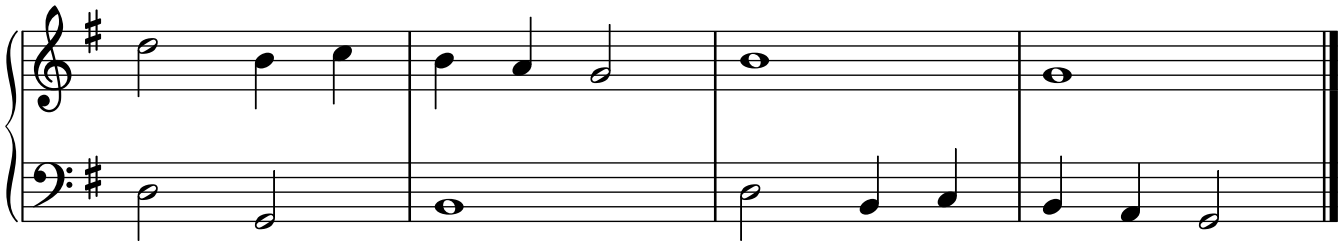


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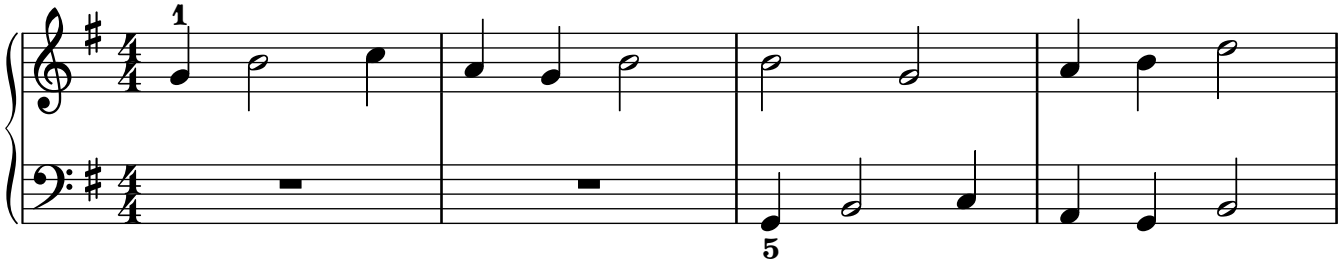


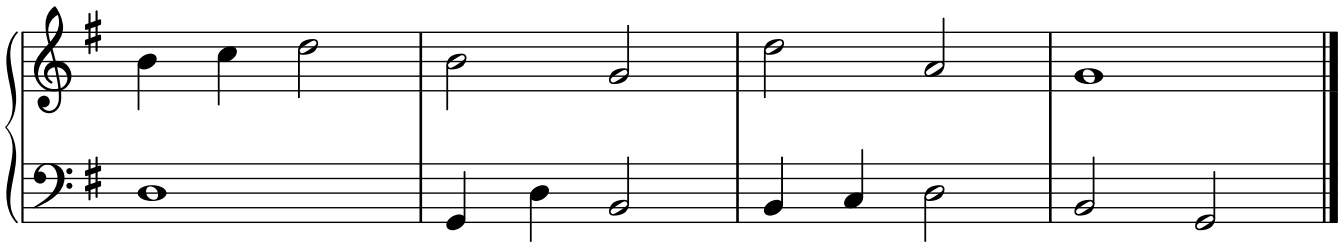
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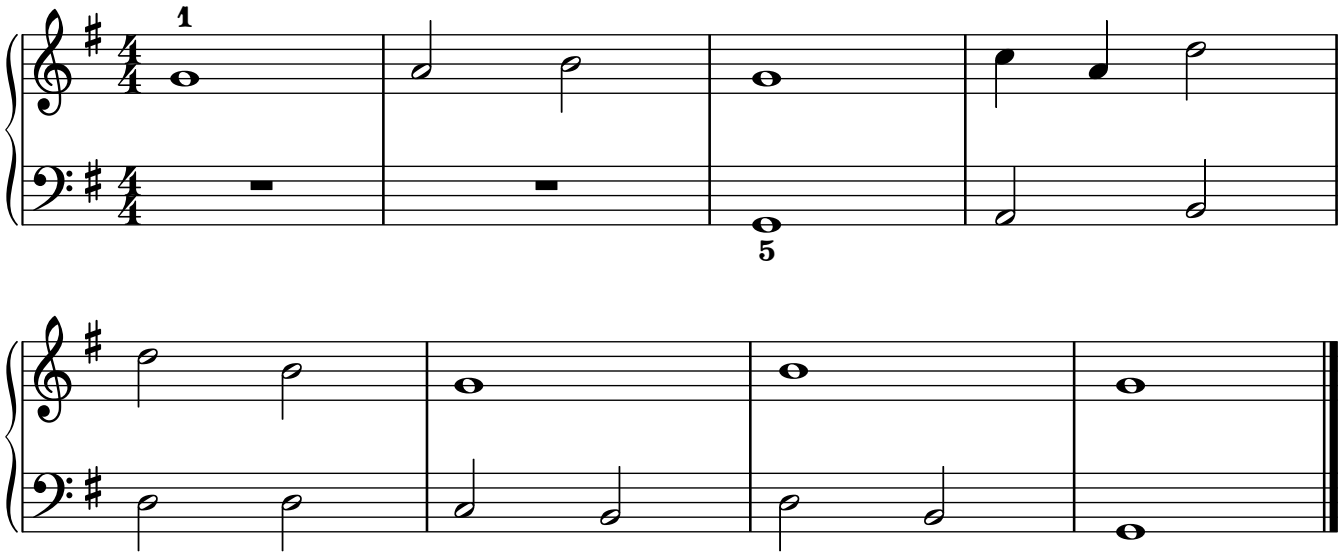


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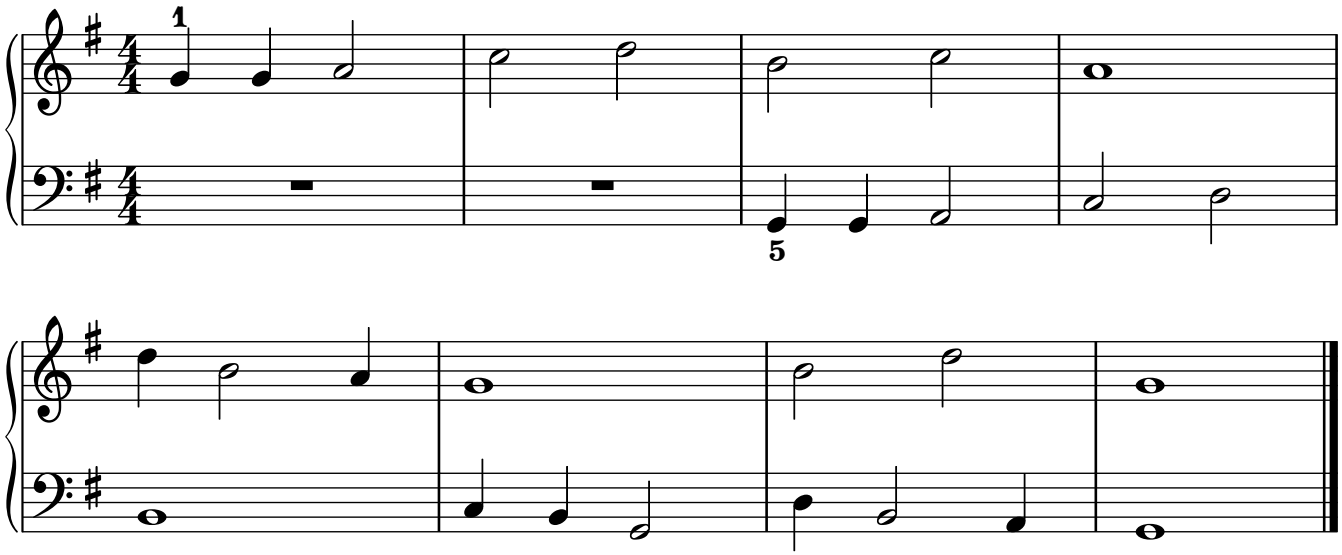




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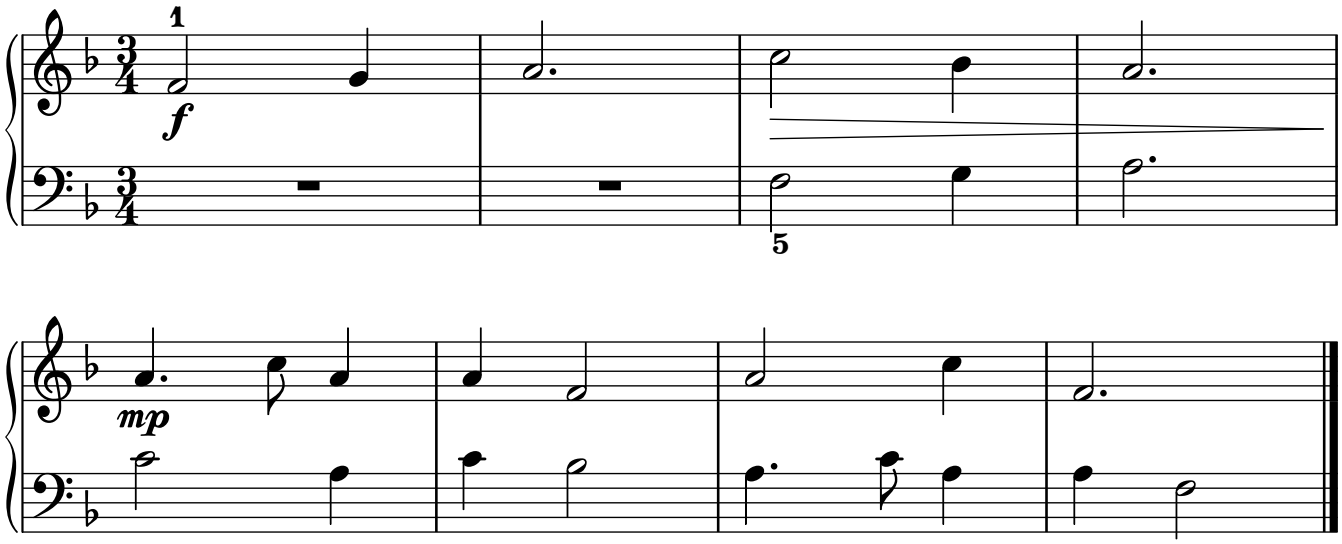
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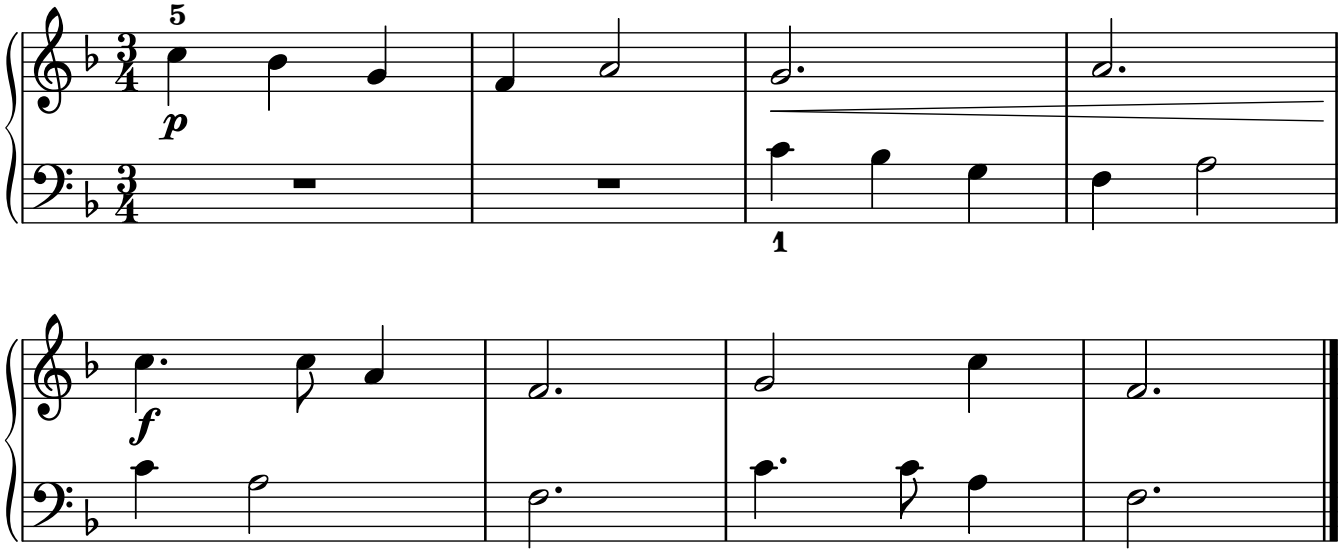


Part C: Imitation in 3/4 ♩ = 72

F major in 3/4.
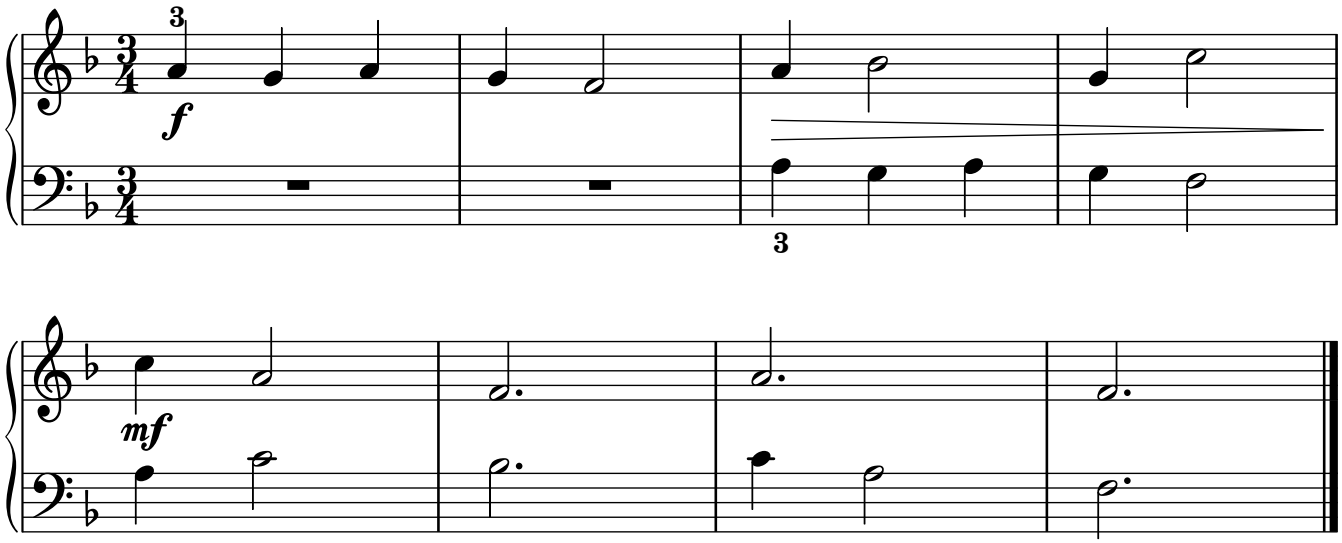
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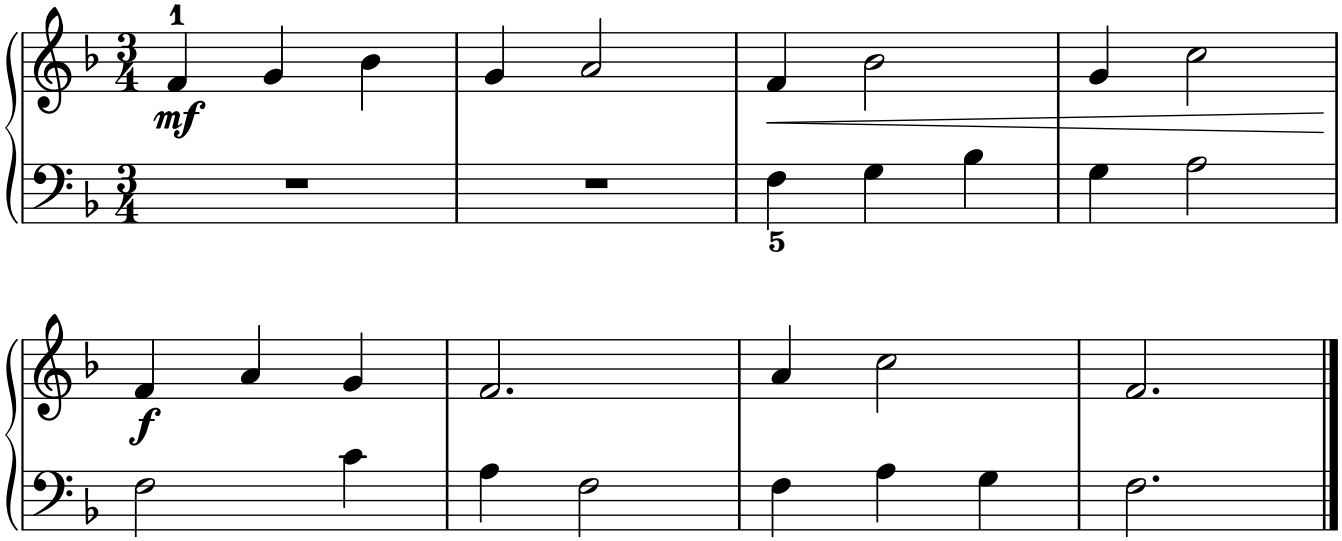


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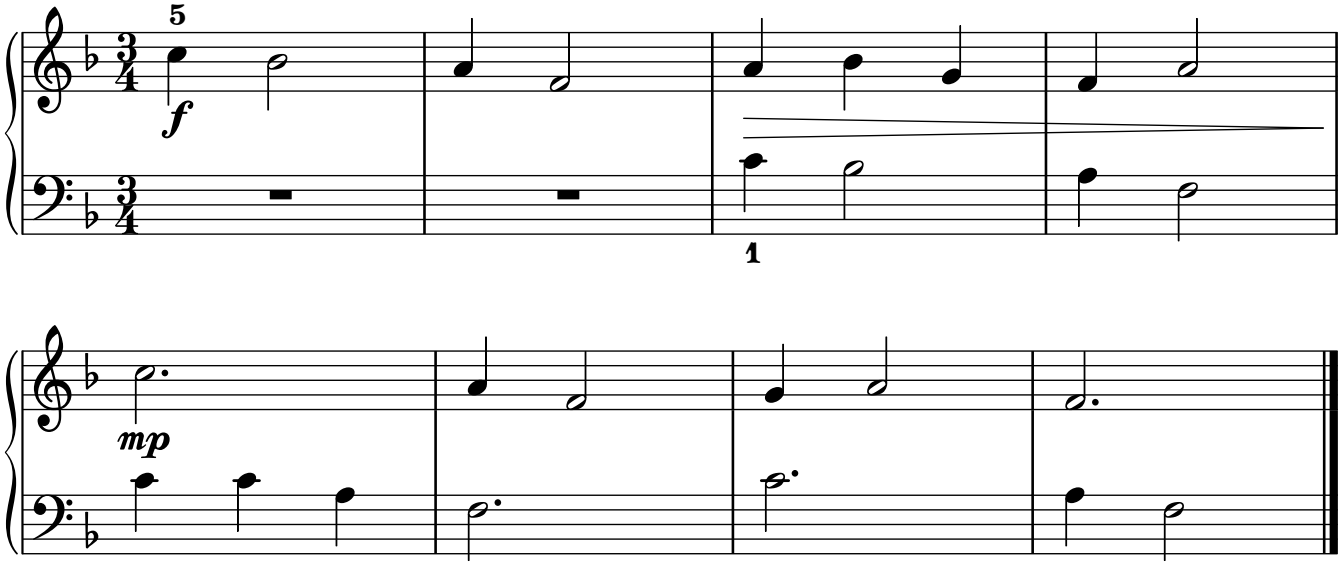


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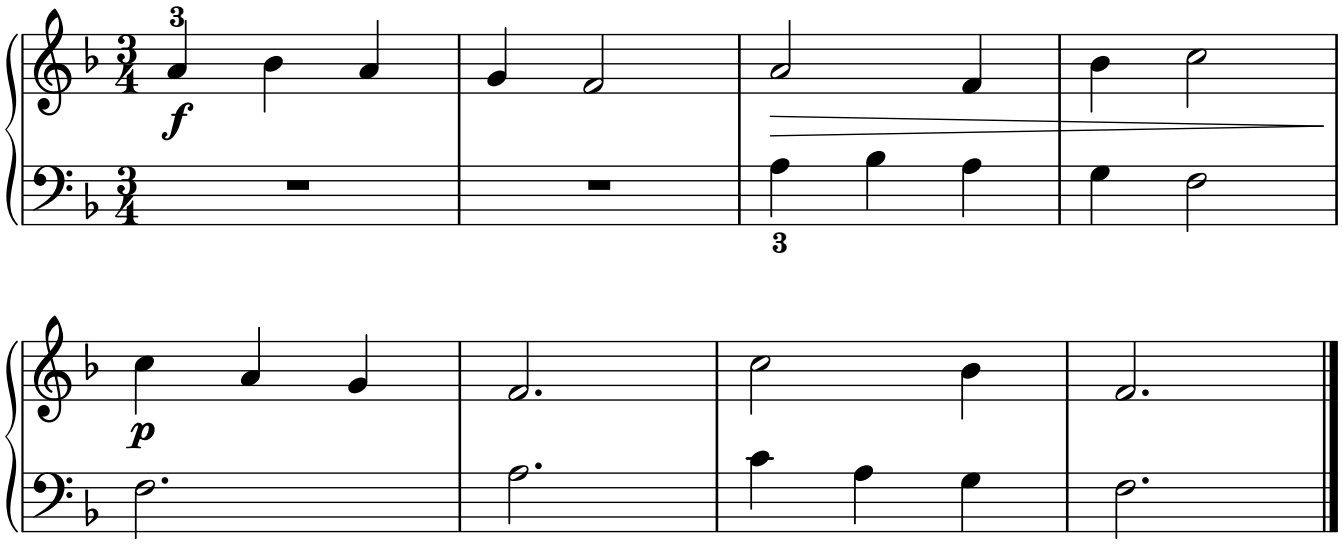


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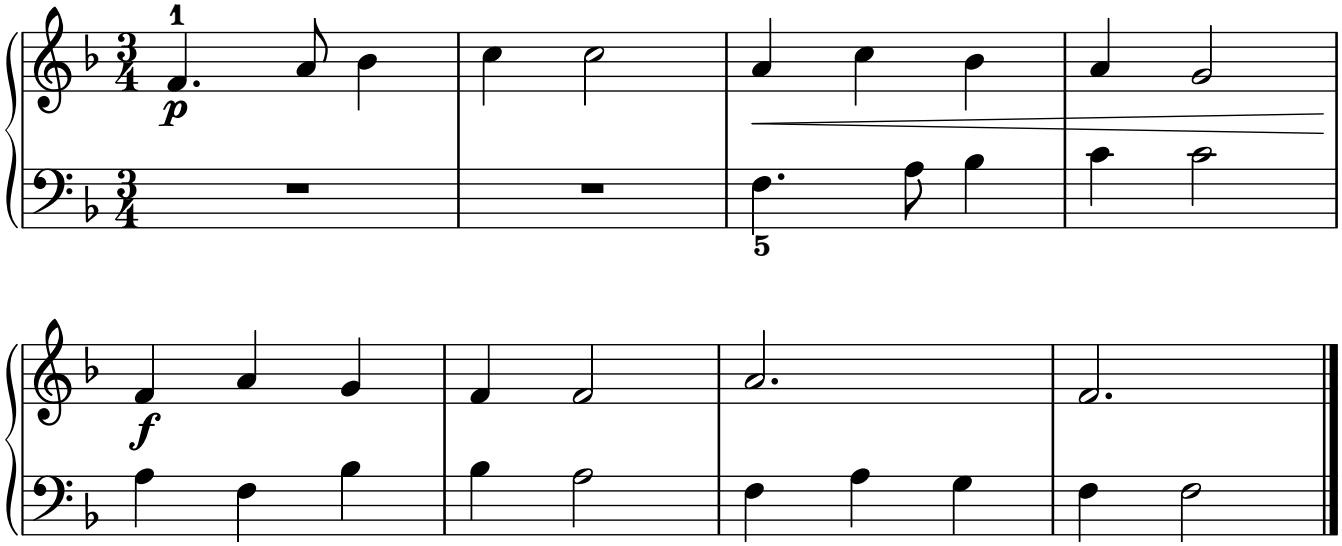


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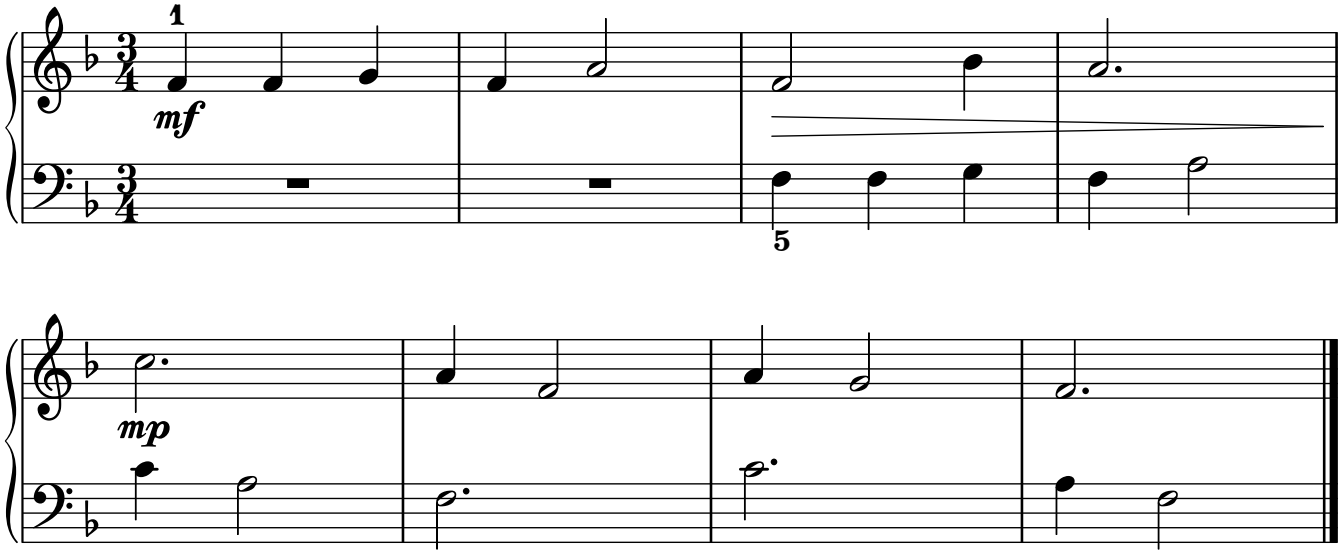


9.24



9.25



9.26
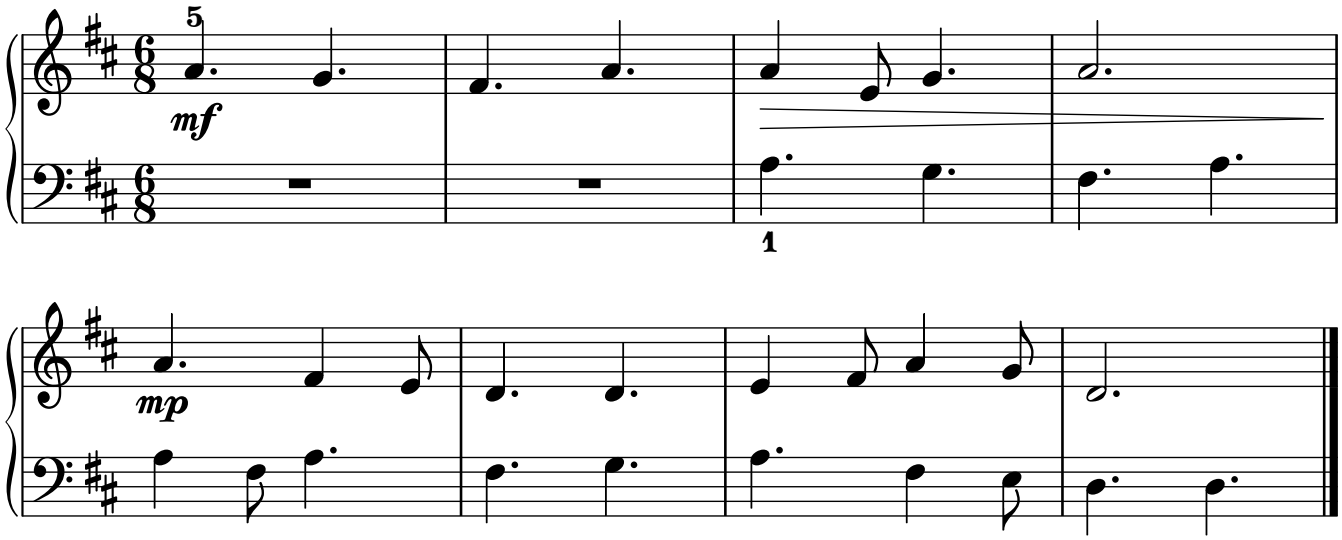


Part D: Imitation in 6/8
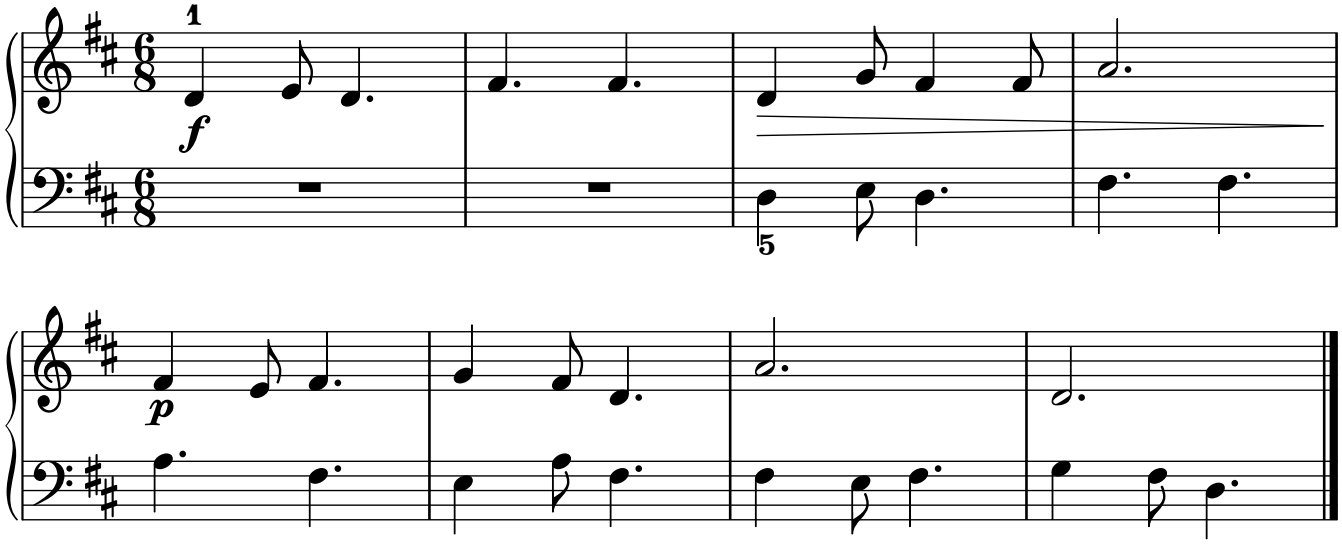
♩. = 50

D major in 6/8.
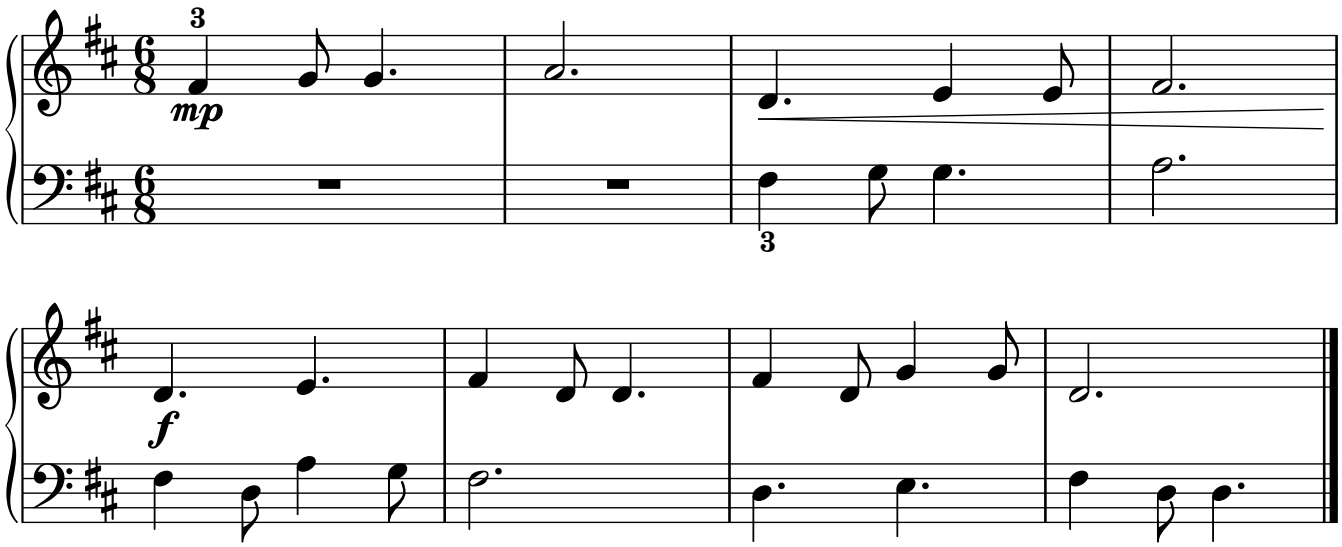
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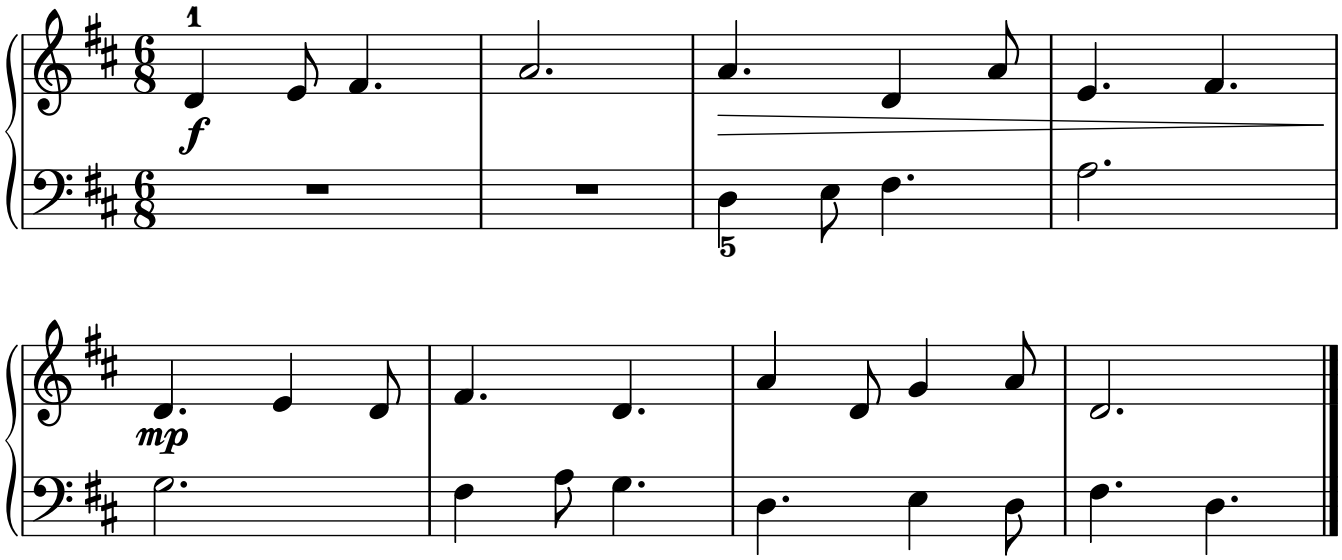


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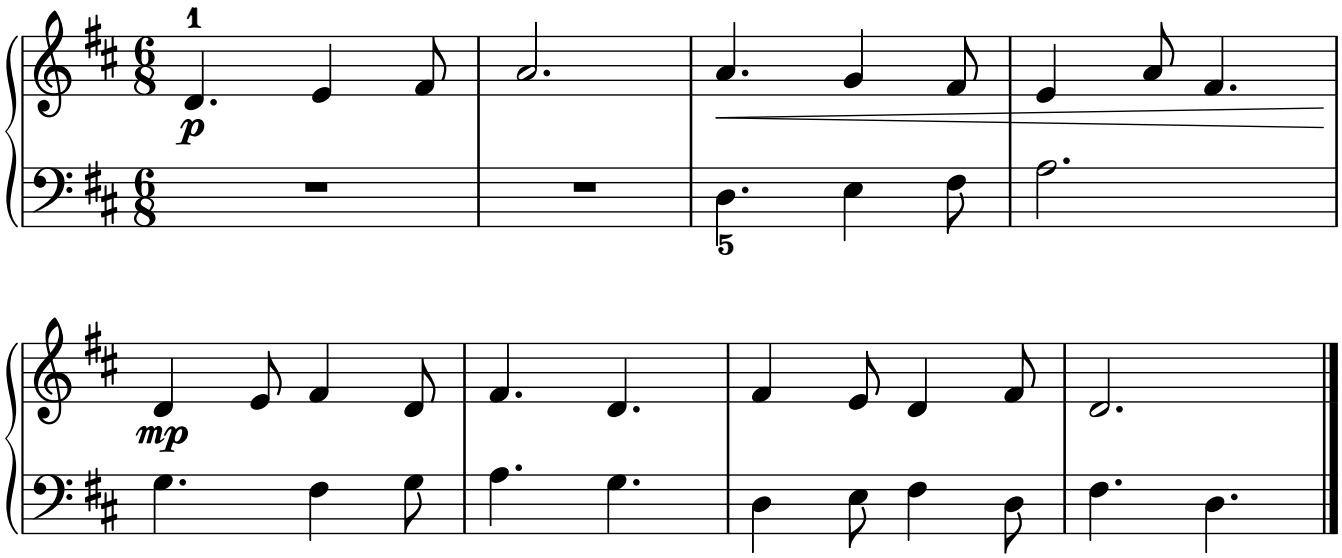


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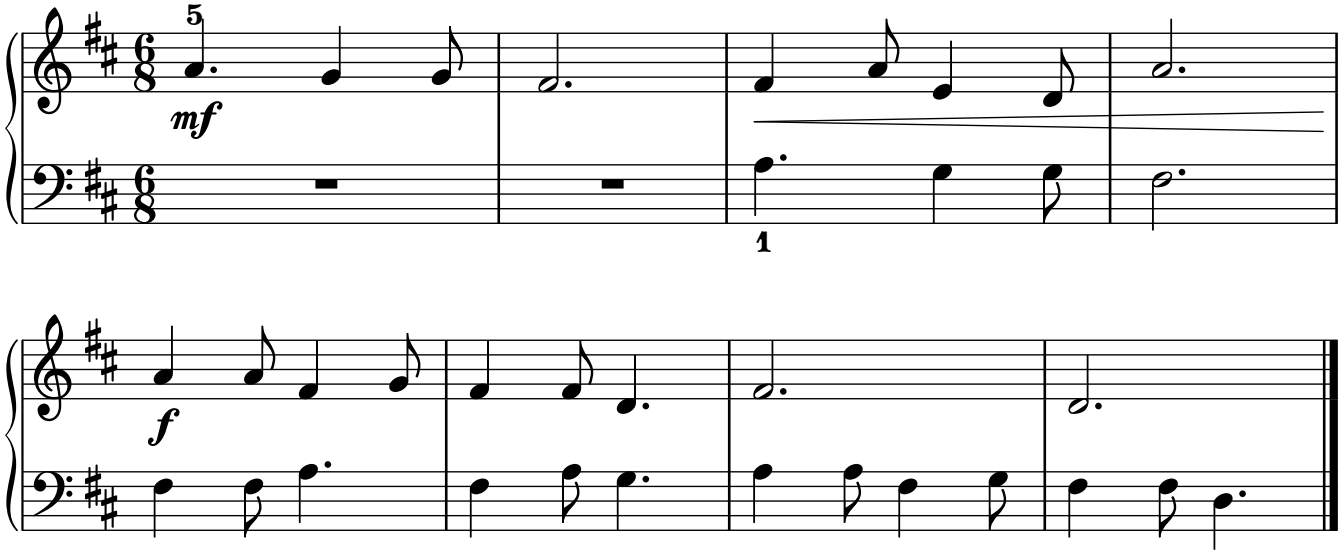


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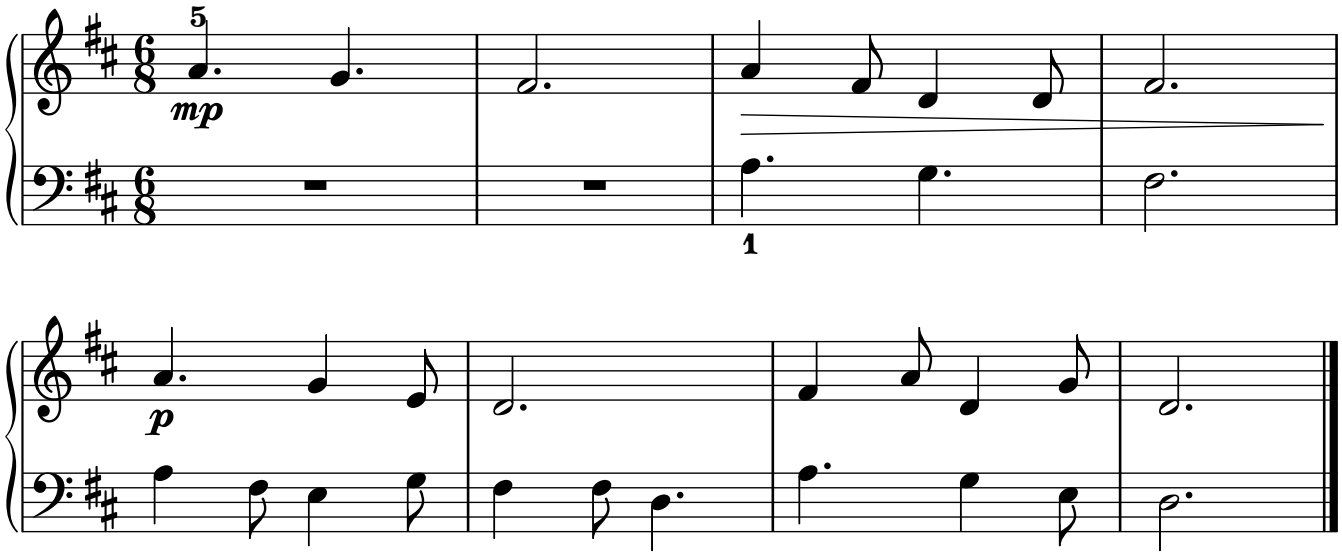


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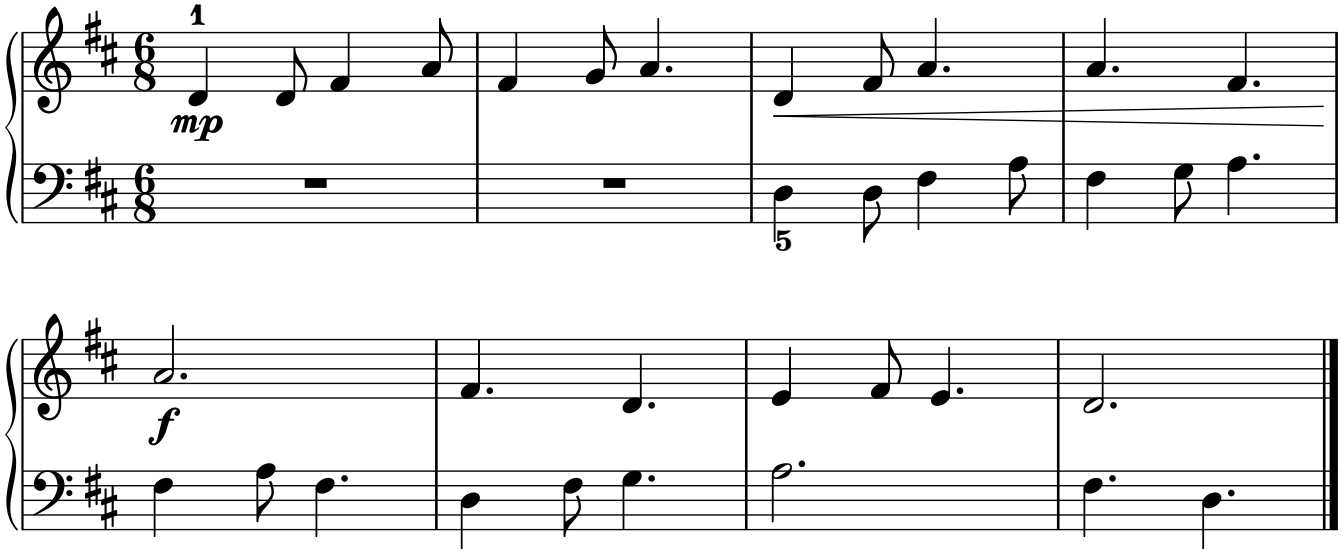


9.32



☐ **9.33**



☐ **9.34**
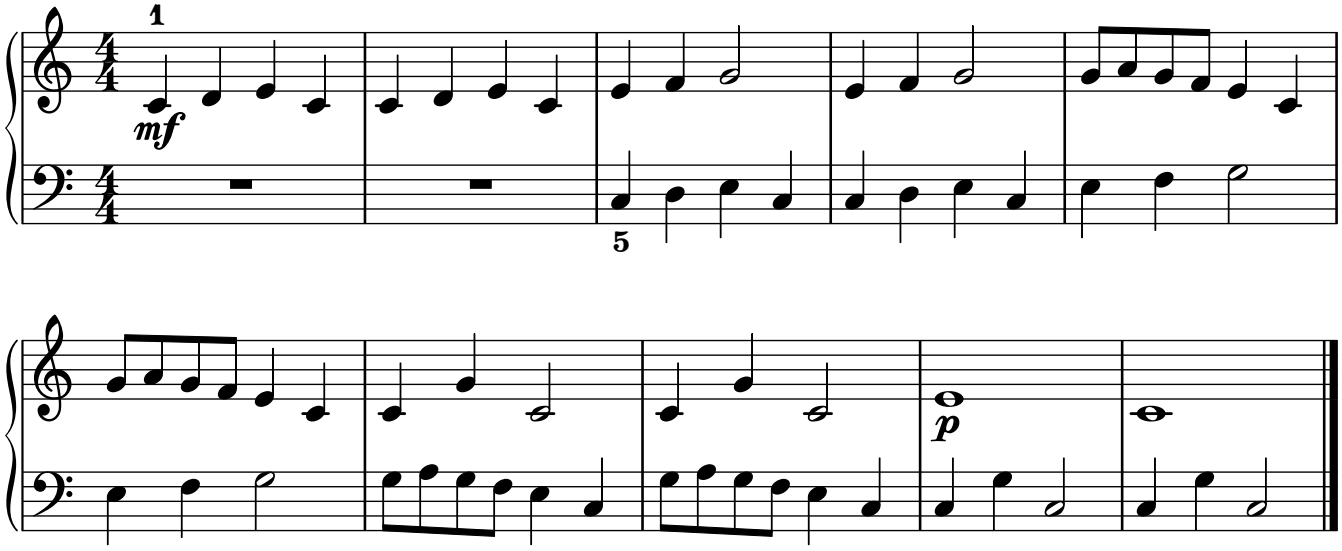


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Frère Jacques ♩ = 84

Traditional French round - simplified
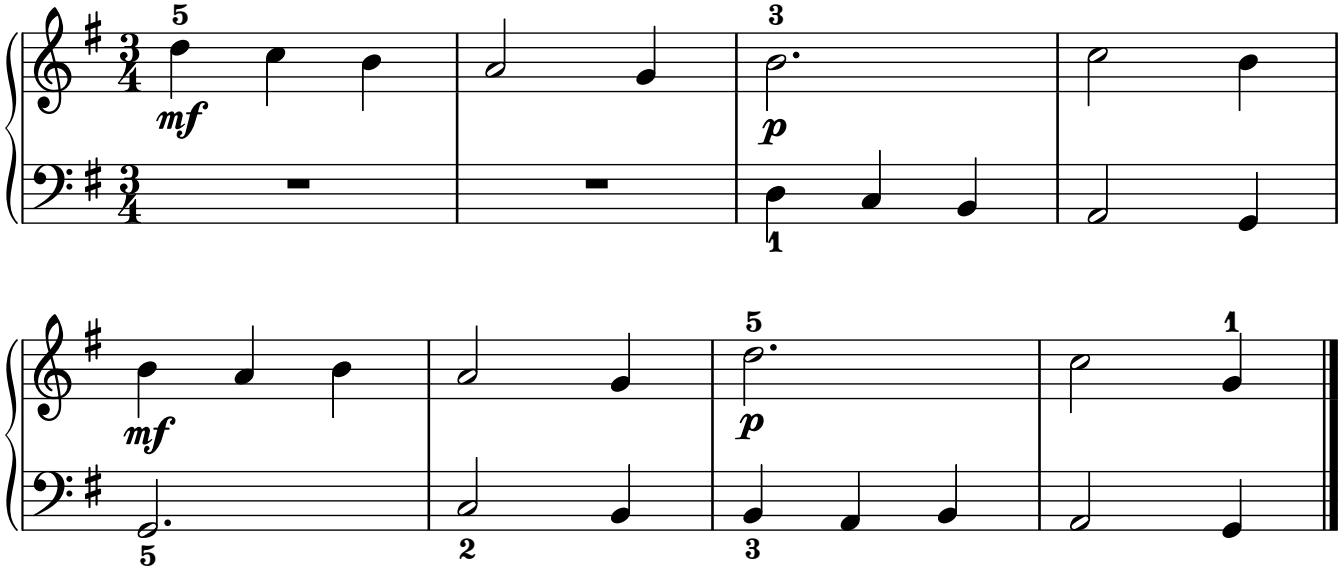
A round: the left hand starts the same song two bars after the right hand. In the last line of the tune each hand jumps up to G instead of down.



Echo Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

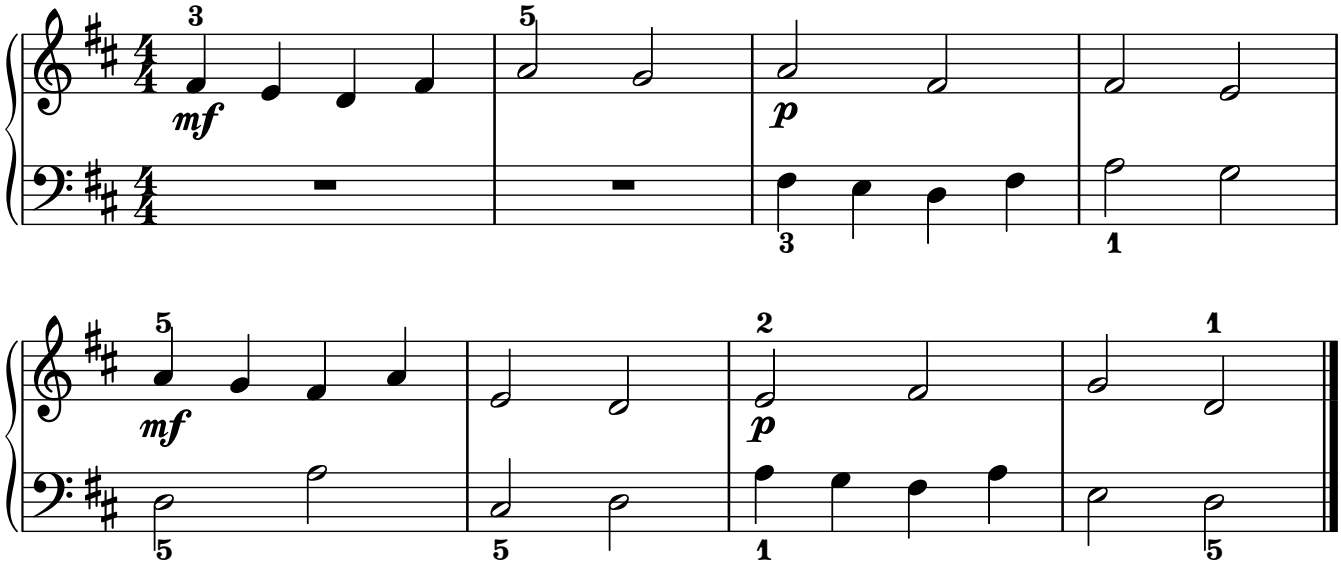
Two little tunes, each echoed two octaves lower by the left hand, under long right-hand notes.



Follow the Leader ♩ = 80

Original

Each two-bar tune is copied an octave lower by the left hand, in D position. In bar 6 the left hand stretches finger 5 down to C-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 10?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- The left hand comes in on time, and the tune passes clearly from hand to hand. Then move on to Unit 10.